



Slovenian / University

From Scan to Minute

The case for research that reaches the table on time



Why Slop University

There is a distance, in most institutions, between the moment a signal is noticed and the moment it becomes a decision. It runs through inboxes and working groups and the slow sediment of agendas, and by the time it surfaces the thing that prompted it has often moved on. Slop University was organised to close that distance.

We are a research university built around a single, unfashionable conviction: that research earns its keep when it arrives in time to be used. Our schools do not produce findings and hope they are read. They produce findings that travel — from the sensing array to the register, from the register to the committee table, from the table to the minute that records what was decided — as one continuous motion, without losing a beat.

This brochure is an invitation to support that motion. The instruments that sense, the registers that hold, and the review cadences that carry a signal through to a decision are not free, and they do not maintain themselves. What follows is the case for keeping them running — and for the researchers who have made the University's evidence move at the speed of its choices.



At a glance

The shape of a university that treats responsiveness as an outcome in its own right.



Always sensing

The Horizon Register runs without a close of business. Something is always arriving, and the University is organised to be listening when it does.



One continuous path

From signal to register to committee, the University's evidence travels a single route — designed so that nothing has to be rediscovered at each handover.



Findable and citable

Every output the University names is published open access under a persistent identifier, so the record a decision rests on can always be looked up.



Decisions with a trail

When a signal becomes a minute, the path it took is kept. The University holds that a decision you can retrace is a decision you can improve.

Where ideas count

The scan never stops

The University's sensing work begins at the School of Emergent Priorities, whose Horizon Register keeps a rolling account of the priorities on approach. It is not an annual exercise or a report that lands and sits; it is a live instrument, revised as the horizon revises itself, and read by the parts of the institution that have to act.

The point of a register that never closes is that the institution is never caught out. A signal noticed on a Tuesday does not wait for the next planning round; it enters the record while it is still current, classified and routed toward whoever most needs to see it. The research group behind the work has spent years understanding how a signal moves once it is logged — and how to keep it moving.



“The register never really closes. Something is always arriving, and our job is to make sure the institution is listening when it does.”

— Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Horizon Register, School of Emergent Priorities

Straight to the table

A signal that stays in a register is only half of the University’s ambition. The other half is the committee table — the standing rooms where an institution decides what it will do — and the work of making sure that what was sensed arrives there intact.

This is where the School’s research on deliberation earns its support. The University has invested in understanding how a scanning item becomes an agenda item: how it is narrowed, how it is worded, and what survives the journey from an open question to a recorded decision. The aspiration is plain, and the University does not apologise for it: the distance between a signal and a minute should be as short as the institution can responsibly make it.



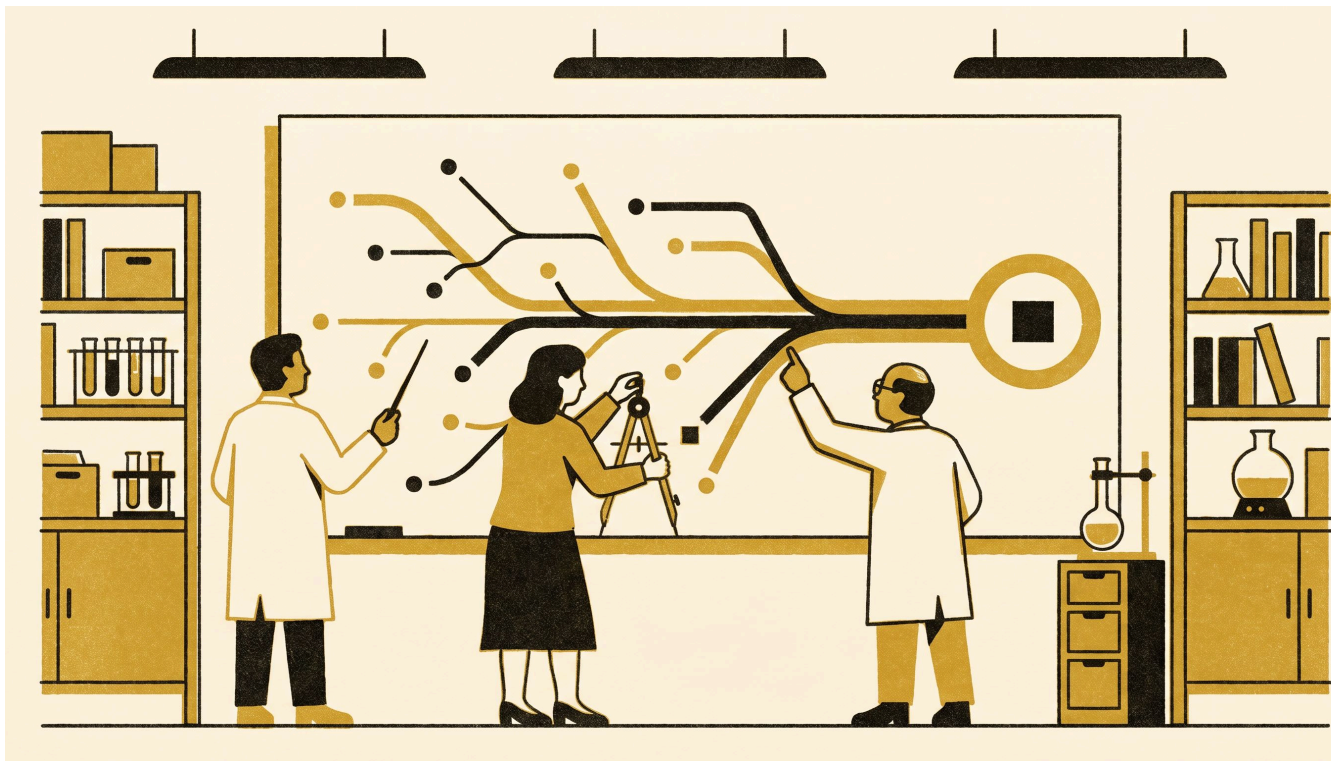
“The distance between a signal and a decision used to be measured in committees. We have been working, patiently, to make that distance disappear.”

— Ingrid Vasseur, Lecturer and Convenor, Futures in Committee, School of Emergent Priorities

One path, end to end

What ties the University’s work together is the trajectory itself: the single, traceable line that runs from the first sensing of a priority through to the decision it eventually shapes. The Trajectory Analytics Group holds that line in view — studying where signals converge, where they stall, and where the institution loses the thread between what it noticed and what it did.

Support for this work is support for continuity. An instrument that senses without a register that holds, or a register that holds without a cadence that carries its contents to a decision, is an instrument working against itself. The University’s case for support is a case for the whole path, kept in calibration end to end, so that research does not merely inform the institution’s choices but compiles cleanly into them.



Read the work

The University's argument is best made by its own record. Each of the following is published open access and can be looked up in full; together they trace the path this brochure describes, from the sensing array to the recorded decision.

- **The Domain-Coverage Router** — a close read of how the Horizon Register routes its scanning work, and where the genuinely novel signals end up concentrating. [doi:10.5555/slop.vxfh17](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.vxfh17)
- **Relocated, Not Restricted** — what becomes of a horizon item after the sensitivity gate redacts it, and who can still reconstruct it from the record. [doi:10.5555/slop.tft4f5](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.tft4f5)
- **The Minute as Alibi** — how a committee's growing power to summarise itself relates to how verifiable its decisions remain. [doi:10.5555/slop.umzrp7](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.umzrp7)
- **Grandfathered In** — a study of horizon-scan recommendations that outlive the signal that first justified them, and are renewed all the same. [doi:10.5555/slop.ogya0h](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.ogya0h)

The people behind the work

The University's evidence moves because its researchers have made moving it their subject. Two of them anchor the path this brochure follows.

Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor of the Horizon Register in the School of Emergent Priorities, studies how an item enters a rolling register, how it is revised, and what its edit history reveals about the institution that logged it. Her work is the front of the University's sensing capability.

Ingrid Vasseur, Lecturer and Convenor of Futures in Committee, follows the same signal to the other end of its journey — the point where a scanning exercise's open questions become an agenda item, a recommendation, and a minute. Between them, they hold both ends of the line the University exists to keep unbroken.

Be part of it

Instruments stay calibrated because someone keeps them so. The sensing arrays, the registers, and the review cadences that let Slop University's research reach the table on time are sustained by those who believe an institution should be able to act on what it knows, while it still knows it.

Your support keeps the path open. It funds the quiet infrastructure between a signal and a decision — the part no ranking counts and no one notices until it stops. Partner with the University, and you make possible not a single finding but the whole continuous motion by which findings become choices.

To learn how to support the work, visit slop.university.



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